# Mario Sanchez

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Sr. Professional Services Consultant, AI Security at Palo Alto Networks with 9+ years of customer-facing experience spanning Technical Support, Customer Success, Solutions Architecture, and Professional Services, and a Senior Network Security Engineer background. Started the AI Security consulting role in March 2026. Previously embedded as the dedicated technical advisor for one of PANW's largest global SASE engagements (100,000+ users, 34+ regions across AWS, Azure, and GCP environments). Pioneer in applying Large Language Model tools to security operations with documented productivity gains adopted at the team level. Hands-on Python and Terraform automation, AI/ML security research including OWASP Top 10 for LLMs (prompt injection, data leakage, model poisoning), and deep expertise across PAN-OS, Prisma Access, Prisma Cloud, and NGFW platforms. Seeking to leverage consulting experience and AI-enhanced engineering skills to deliver AI Model Scanning and AI Red Teaming engagements at enterprise scale.

## PROJECTS

**AI-Integrated Security Infrastructure Lab** *2023 to Present*

Architect and operate a 50+ service security research environment across a 4-node Proxmox cluster with 50+ VMs/containers, PA-440 NGFW (PAN-OS 11.2), and defense-in-depth security across 6 VLANs. Deploy local Large Language Model inference (Ollama/PyTorch) and AI agent pipelines for security research, including testing OWASP Top 10 LLM threats (prompt injection, data leakage, model poisoning) and AI model scanning workflows. Implement Terraform and Ansible-driven infrastructure-as-code with Docker, Kubernetes-compatible container orchestration, and Semaphore CI/CD. Manage centralized SIEM (Graylog + OpenSearch), XDR (Wazuh with CIS compliance), Prometheus/Grafana observability, and MLOps-style automation pipelines.

**Prisma Access DNS Automation Engine** *2025*

Designed Python automation for DNS configuration management across 18 global Prisma Access regions, managing 150 internal domains simultaneously. Reduced deployment time from 25-35 hours to under 1 minute (99.9% reduction), eliminating 2,700+ individual manual entries and potential human error.

**SCM Address Group Converter** -GitHub *2025*

Built enterprise Python tool using Strata Cloud Manager SDK to convert static address groups to dynamic tag-based groups at scale. Features OAuth 2.0 authentication, intelligent batch processing (200-400 objects/min), comprehensive backup/rollback, and exponential backoff retry logic.

## EXPERIENCE

**Sr. Professional Services Consultant, AI Security (Prisma AIRS)**

**Palo Alto Networks** | Santa Clara, CA *March 2026 to Present*

- Implement AI gateways to integrate security controls into AI application traffic flows.
- Configure AI guardrails and API security controls for AI application integrations.
- Conduct AI red teaming to assess adversarial behavior and identify security weaknesses.

**Sr. Network Security Engineer (Prisma Access, SSE)**

**Palo Alto Networks** | Santa Clara, CA (Embedded at Fortune 500 Clients) *Dec 2020 to February 2026*

- Subject matter expert and embedded senior technical engineer leading global Prisma Access deployments for Fortune 500 organizations: 100,000+ users across 34+ regions worldwide, acting as single technical bridge between customer leadership, PANW engineering, TAC, and partner teams
- Developed Python automation tools using PAN-OS SDK and Strata Cloud Manager API that reduced DNS configuration management from 25-35 hours to under 1 minute across 18 global regions, eliminating 2,700+ manual entries with 100% accuracy
- Pioneered AI-enhanced engineering workflows using Large Language Model tools (Claude, Gemini) for configuration review, technical analysis, and automated reporting, saving 5-10 hours/week with practices requested by management for company-wide adoption. Evaluated data leakage risks and implemented guardrails for secure AI tool usage in enterprise context
- Led GlobalProtect client rollout expansion from 2,000 to 52,000+ users with 2,500 users/day peak deployment, resolving critical cross-platform authentication and captive portal issues through hands-on field testing and structured troubleshooting methodologies
- Engineered strategic China tenant architecture pivot, migrating mobile users to global tenant via Hong Kong/Singapore; proactively identified BGP timer misconfigurations and DNS session issues before they caused outages for thousands of users

- Delivered technical workshops, presentations, and strategic recommendations to executive stakeholders through weekly business updates and quarterly business reviews, aligning security posture with enterprise digital transformation objectives
- Built enterprise Python and Terraform-ready automation tools including SCM SDK address group converter with OAuth 2.0 authentication, batch processing at 200-400 objects/minute, and reusable delivery templates for global scaling
- Identified and remediated 4,000 disabled rules, 1,100+ unused services, and 600+ unused address objects in Panorama, building reusable documentation and cleanup methodologies adopted across engagements
- Collaborated with Product and Engineering teams channeling field insights into product development, including early adoption and feedback for SCM cloning tool and Prisma Access proxy features

**Customer Engineer, Network Security (Prisma Access, SSE)**
**Palo Alto Networks** | Santa Clara, CA *Aug 2019 to Dec 2020*

- Drove 40% Prisma Access adoption across 20 enterprise clients through solutions architecture, cloud security assessments on AWS and Azure environments, and deployment of cloud-native SASE solutions
- Led migration of 10,000+ L4/L7 proxy rules to Palo Alto NGFW explicit proxy and security policies, reducing policy conflicts by 60% and boosting network performance by 20%
- Designed Zero Trust architectures including secure web gateways, network segmentation, and advanced packet inspection for multinational enterprise networks across public cloud platforms
- Delivered operational presentations and quarterly business reviews to executive stakeholders, aligning security strategies with enterprise digital transformation objectives

**Technical Support Engineer (Prisma Access, SSE)**
**Palo Alto Networks** | Santa Clara, CA *Jul 2017 to Aug 2019*

- Provided customer-facing technical support for cloud-based NGFW firewalls, Panorama, and early Prisma Access platform, troubleshooting routing, VPN, and security issues across enterprise deployments
- Hardened authentication implementations with SAML, SSO, and MFA integrations (Okta, Azure AD) for enterprise customers on AWS, Azure, and GCP cloud platforms
- Collaborated with engineering teams on complex technical escalations, contributing field insights that informed product development and improvement cycles

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

**Security & Cloud Platforms:** Prisma Access (SASE/SSE), Prisma Cloud, PAN-OS NGFW, Panorama, GlobalProtect, ZTNA 2.0, Strata Cloud Manager, Zero Trust Architecture, AWS, Azure, GCP, SSL/TLS Decryption, Network Segmentation

**AI/ML Security & Automation:** Large Language Models (LLM Security), OWASP Top 10 for LLMs, Prompt Injection / Data Leakage / Model Poisoning, AI Model Scanning, AI Red Teaming, LLM Inference (Ollama/PyTorch), MLOps Pipelines, AI Agent Security

**Programming & IaC:** Python (PAN-OS SDK, SCM SDK, Pydantic, OAuth 2.0), Terraform, REST API Automation, Infrastructure-as-Code (Ansible, Docker Compose), CI/CD (Semaphore)

**Infrastructure & Containers:** Docker, Kubernetes (familiar), Podman, Proxmox VE, Linux (Debian/Ubuntu), LXC Containers, Cloudflare Tunnel/Access

**Monitoring & SecOps:** Graylog/OpenSearch (SIEM), Prometheus/Grafana, Wazuh XDR, CIS Benchmarks, SNMP/Syslog

## EDUCATION

**AA Network Administration** -Mission College, Santa Clara, CA

## CERTIFICATIONS

**PCNSE - Palo Alto Networks Certified Network Security Engineer** *Certified 2019; recertified 2024*
**CCNA CyberOps (Cisco)** *2018*
**CCNA Security (Cisco)** *2017*
**CCNA Routing & Switching (Cisco)** *2016*